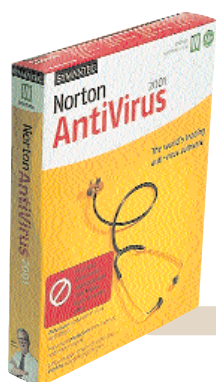


ANTI-VIRUS SOFTWARE

We know that the viruses are getting resilient and insidious and are wreaking more havoc—the real trick lies in updated, robust protection. Anti-virus software have evolved greatly over the past year to tackle the ever increasingly complexity of newer threats to your data, whether through e-mail, files or even through unshielded network connections. One of the most persistent threats that we've seen has been in the form of Trojans and worms that have been spreading through malicious e-mails. Anti-virus software have evolved to tackle these threats effectively or at least protect your computer against them.

Viruses will continue to propagate primarily over the Internet. Every year the amount of data and time lost due to viruses continues to increase. The amount of bandwidth consumed by most of the new viruses that use the Internet to propagate is also considerable. The latest worms take advantage of flaws in software to infect PCs through Web browsers, mail clients and now even via instant messengers. The only advice that we have for the future is: stay paranoid.



Norton AntiVirus 2001

Simple wizards for most common tasks and the ability to automate tasks help take virus worries off your mind

NAV 2001 has an excellent cleaning and detection rate. The AutoProtect feature runs in the background and detects viruses in attachments before they can do damage, while LiveUpdate ensures that you have the latest definitions and patches installed. Increased protection comes to you with SmartScan, which scans all file types for malicious code and Script Blocking, which specifically monitors JavaScript and ActiveX components.

+ Simple wizards for most common tasks

+ High detection and repair rates

Price: Not available

Contact: Tech Pacific

Phone: 022-5960238

Fax: 022-5961012

Web site: www.symantec.com

E-mail: info@bom.nand.com

Reviewed in: June 2001

Worthy Mentions

AVG Free Edition

+ Good detection rate

+ Free for use

Price: Free for download

Web site: www.grisoft.com

Reviewed in: June 2001

McAfee 5.1

+ User friendly interface

+ Script blocking facility

Price: Not available

Contact: Network Associates

Phone: 022-6935278

Fax: 022-6147078

Web site: www.mcafee.com

Reviewed In: June 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Norton AntiVirus 2001 1999: McAfee Virus Scan 4.0
1998: Norton AntiVirus 5.0

BROWSERS

Over the past year all popular browsers have matured from being just a window to the World Wide Web towards becoming consolidated Internet communication suites with hefty mail clients, integrated messaging clients. There are new rendering engines that include support for the latest Web standards and increased security against worms and Web bugs. Also included are a lot of additional goodies such as an instant messenger, e-mail client, password managers, search engines and even integrated players to allow you to view streaming videos.

It is still unclear what impact .Net is going to have on the Internet, but it is likely to play an important role in the evolution of the browser. Support for Java, which has gained considerable popularity over the last couple of years, has become a bone of contention since Microsoft has decided not to integrate it into IE 6. Since Microsoft's IE is the most popular browser by

a considerable margin, most Web developers will tend to write code specifically for it. This will mean a further deviation from the WWW consortium's standards.



Netscape 6.1

A feature-rich browser that loads up quickly, promises faster surfing and at the same time provides you with some good utilities

With the arrival of the new version 6.1 of their browser, Netscape can now try to make up ground they had lost to the competition not only in market share but also in terms of features and appearance. The new version eliminates most of the quirks that plagued Netscape 6.0. It includes the new Mozilla engine, which is considerably faster at rendering pages and uses significantly less memory. The browser's performance has improved across all parameters and it is now replete with features, is easier to use and has the most options for customisation.

+ Loads up quickly and is stable

+ Pleasant interface and excellent searching capabilities

Price: Free for download

Contact: Netscape

Web site: www.netscape.com

Reviewed in: October 2001

Worthy Mentions

Internet Explorer 6

+ A wealth of features; extremely customisable

+ Less vulnerability to worms and viruses

Price: Free for download

Contact: Microsoft

Web site: www.microsoft.com/ie

Reviewed in: October 2001

Opera 5.12

+ Low on system resources

+ Supports multiple browsing in a single window

Price: Free for download

Contact: Opera Software

Web site: www.opera.com

Reviewed in: October 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Internet Explorer 5.5 1999: NA 1998: Opera